

A little time. A new favorite.

A calmer Mania for brief phone visits over several days.

Book club for albums

Music first. Friends close.

Open your group, see what needs you, and get back to listening.

- 01

The album leads

Artwork and an external listening link stay visible.
- 02

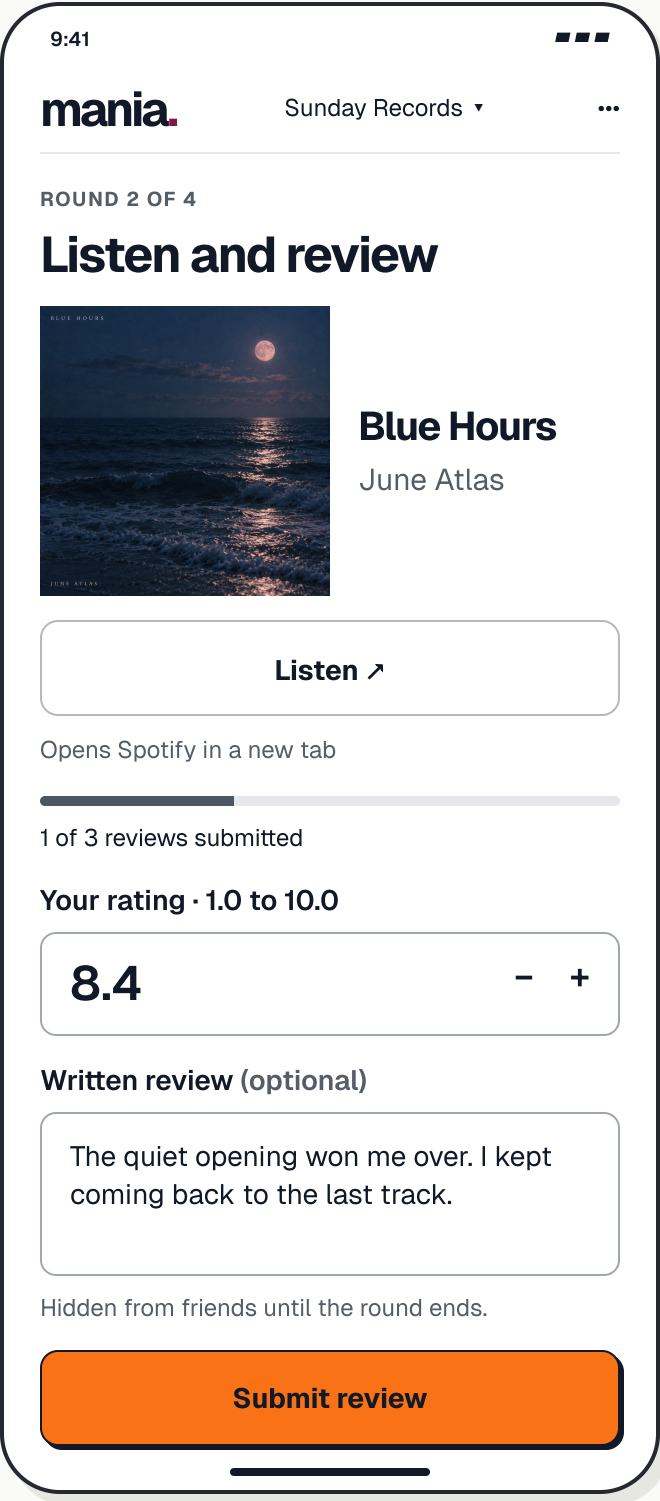
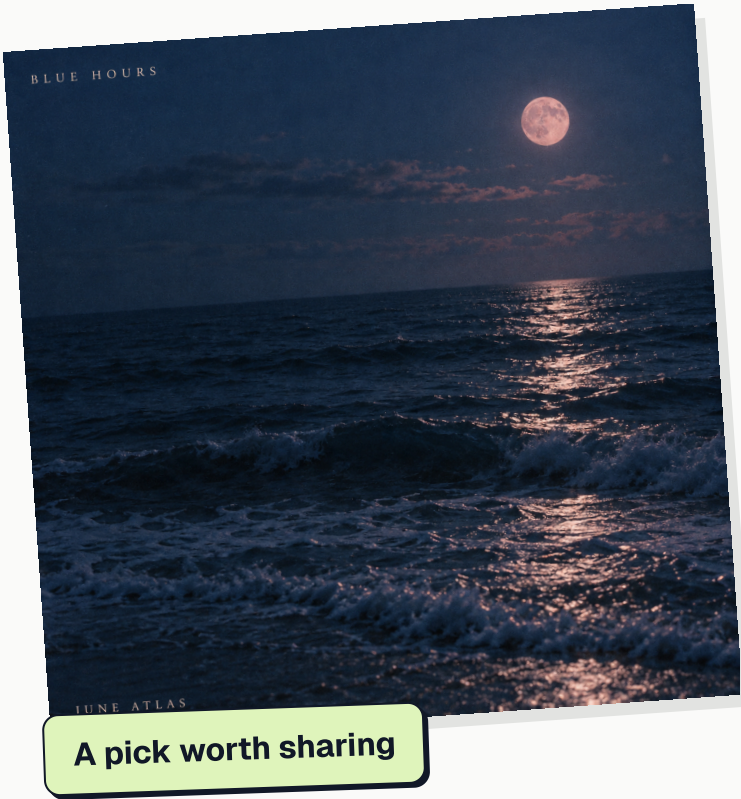
One clear next step

Pick, review, wait, or read what friends thought.
- 03

Personality with room to breathe

Geist, colorful stickers, and quieter surfaces.

Design review deliverable · September 2026
Existing game rules and backend remain the baseline.



Where the current experience gets busy

A source-based reconstruction, not a screenshot or a measured usability study.

Existing route map

/	Public / signed-in landing
/login · /signup	Confirmation and invitation handoff
/play?group=...	Setup + round task + roster + host controls
/results?group=...&game=...	Reveals, album table, statistics
/account	Profile, groups, invitations, history
/reset-password · /auth/callback	Account recovery and authentication

RECONSTRUCTED CURRENT PLAY

Play the round.

This is the working room for your group...

Leave your review

Album, artist and status explanation

Identity Group Invite Round

View results Manage account Refresh

Host controls (if host)

Auto-advance · Round limit · Close early

Review form

Album link · Rating · Quick scores · Notes

Club roster / setup / leave group

Stack condensed to show hierarchy. Sections vary by role and state.

Repeated orientation

The page introduction and status hero both explain Play before the player reaches the task.

Competing emphasis

Borders, shadows, colored panels and nested tiles give administration similar weight to the album.

Context is fragile

Some links preserve the group query; generic Play and Results links can lose it.

The album disappears

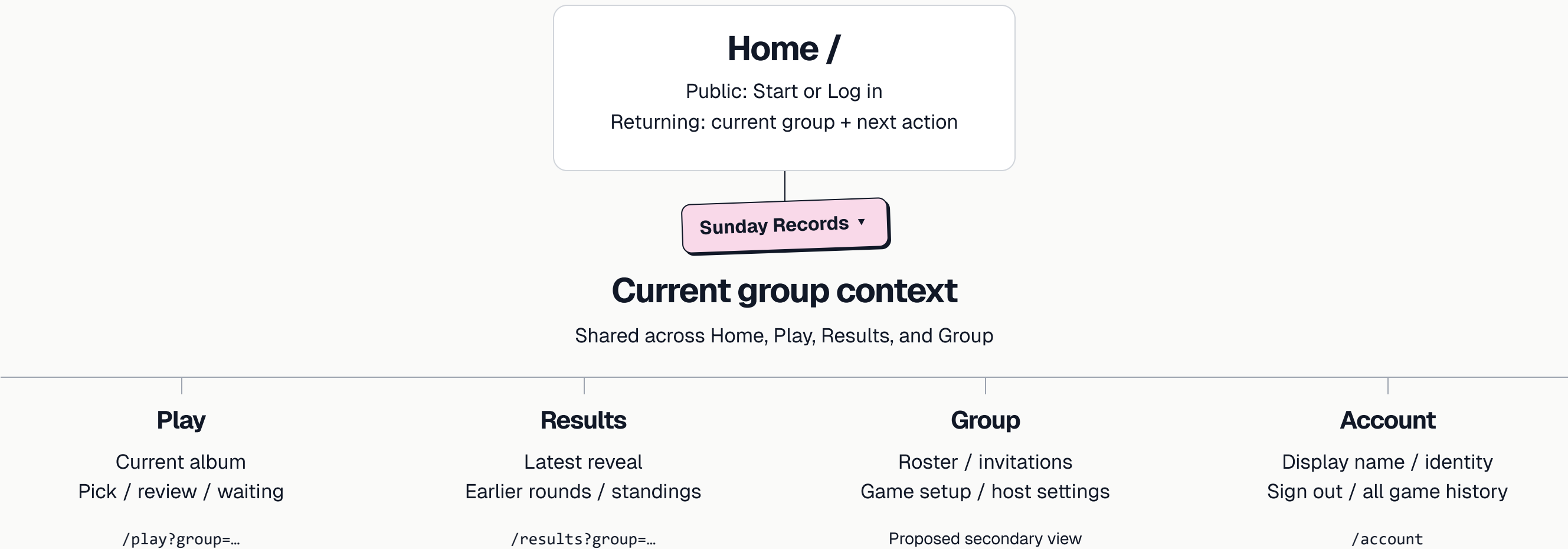
The full listening/review surface is conditional. Submission should not remove the artwork or listening link.

BEFORE Play mixes the round task with the workspace around it.

AFTER Keep the task on Play; give administration a clear Group destination.

Navigation that remembers your group

Home orients. Play handles the current round. Results holds the conversation.



Compact switcher

Show the selected group name, then a short list of memberships. Offer Join group and Create group below it.

Reliable return path

Carry group IDs on every contextual link. History uses its explicit game ID. Back returns to the same group and round.

Persistence proposal

Remember the last valid group locally. An explicit URL wins. If membership changes, show the group chooser instead of a silent switch.

BEFORE Navigation alternates between scoped and generic destinations.

AFTER One group context travels with the player; account settings remain one step away.

The same color, with less noise

Geist stays. Orange marks the primary action. Artwork supplies most of the visual richness.

Aa

Geist Sans

Headings 28–40 px / 700
Body 16 px / 400, line-height 1.5
Labels 14 px / 600

Action
#F97316

Pink
#F9A8D4

Lime
#BEF264

Reveal
#FACC15

Retain green #22C55E and peach #FDBA74 for status accents.
Pair all bright fills with dark text.

Canvas
#FAFAF9

Ink
#111827

Controls with a clear order

Submit review

Listen ↗

Earlier rounds

48 px minimum touch targets. Visible focus ring. A 2 px sticker offset on the primary action only.

Your rating · 1.0 to 10.0

8.4 - +

Quiet surfaces

Use spacing and fine dividers. Save a bordered panel for a form, dialog, or meaningful grouping.

Spacing: 4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 24 / 32 px
Phone gutters: 20 px
Review measure: about 60 characters



Artwork, without cropping

Square covers, 180–280 px on phones. Keep text outside the artwork. Missing covers get a labeled neutral tile.

Plain language

Your pick is due

Choose an album

Open link

Listen

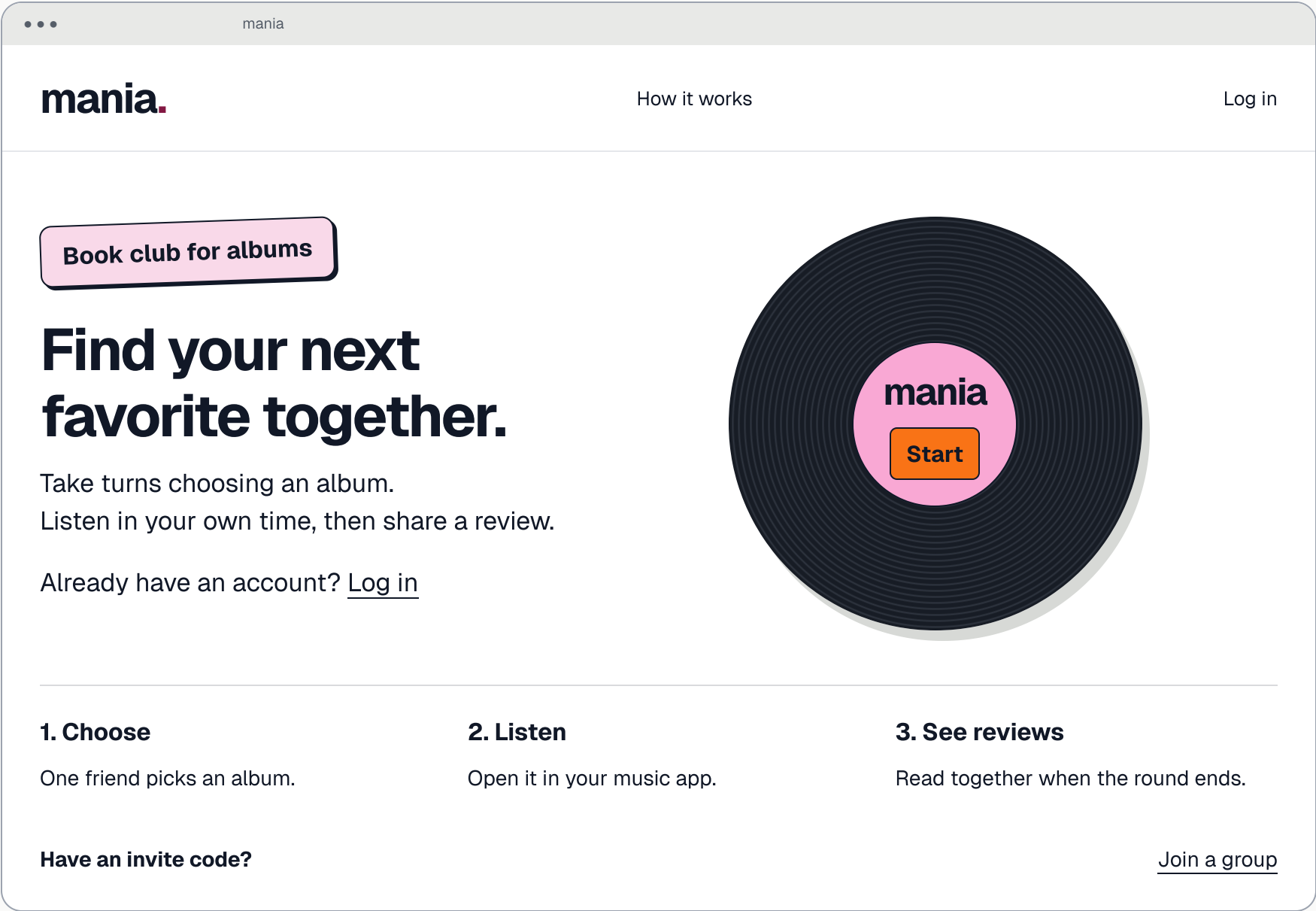
Reveal chaos

See reviews

Dark mode retains existing dark tokens; contrast and focus need a separate implementation check.

A clear invitation to start

The record is the entrance to the game. Listening happens in an external music service.

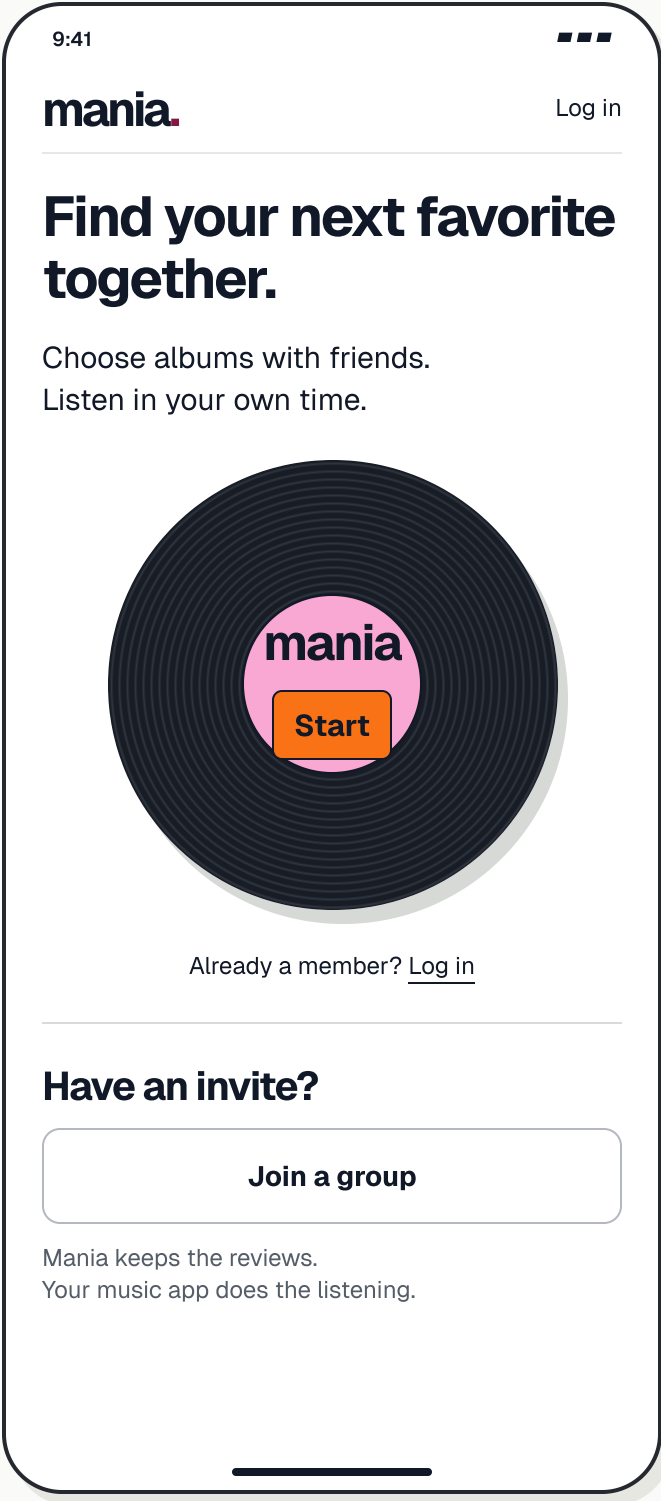


One entry action

The orange Start label belongs to the record button. The whole record is clickable and keyboard accessible.

An honest music metaphor

No transport bar, waveform, volume control, or spinning playback state. Start leads to sign-up, then group setup.

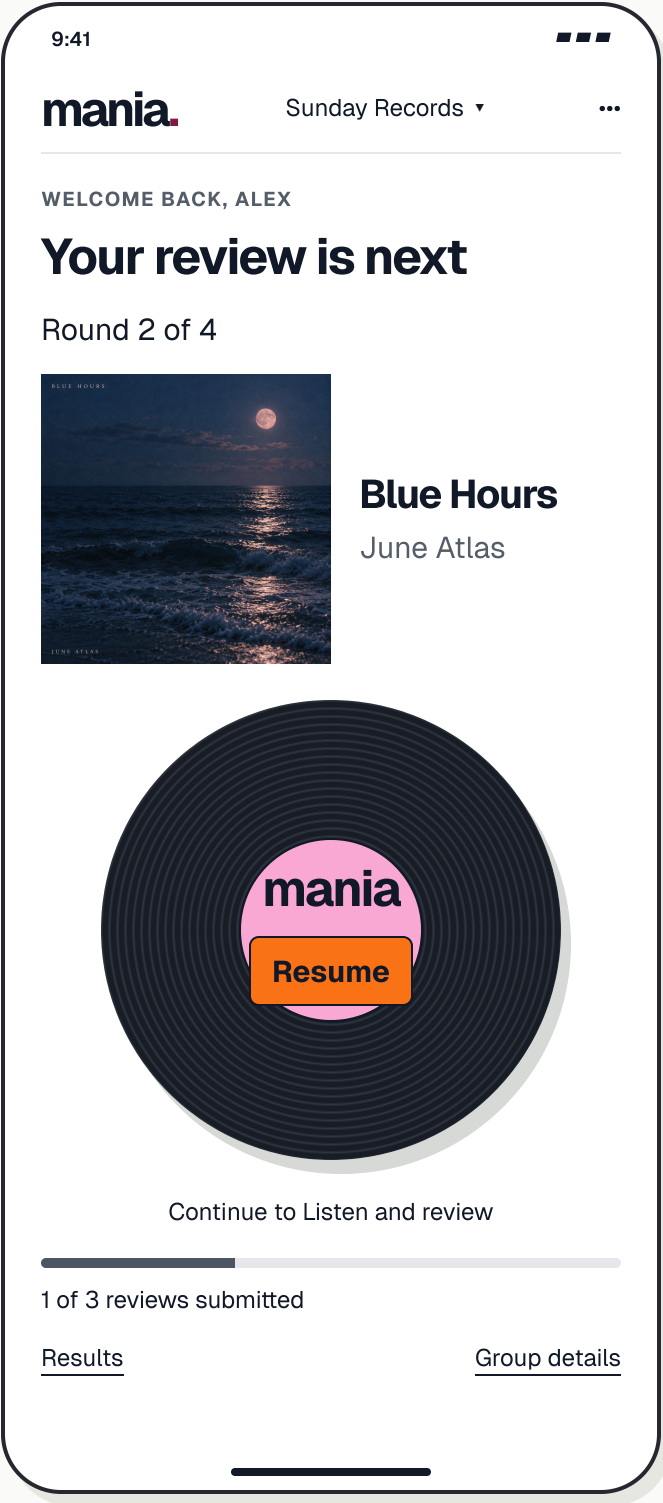


BEFORE Multiple pitches, decorative blocks and repeated entry links compete.

AFTER A short promise and one prominent Start element lead to the existing auth flow.

A familiar place to return

The current group and next action appear immediately, before supporting information.



Group switcher, expanded



Choose what to resume

Use the existing current-game state for the selected group. Do not choose another group because it happens to need action.

No active game

Replace Resume with Open group. In the lobby, any member can create a game and become its host.

Completed game

Use See reviews and an Open group link for starting another game. Do not show Resume on a finished game.

Start / Resume storyboard

- 01

At rest
Record label names the action. A visible caption names the destination.
- 02

On activation
Record shifts slightly, then the label reads “Opening...” while navigation begins.
- 03

At the destination
Play opens on the round heading. Artwork takes visual priority. No audio starts.
- 04

On return
The group stays selected. The next action reflects a fresh server state.

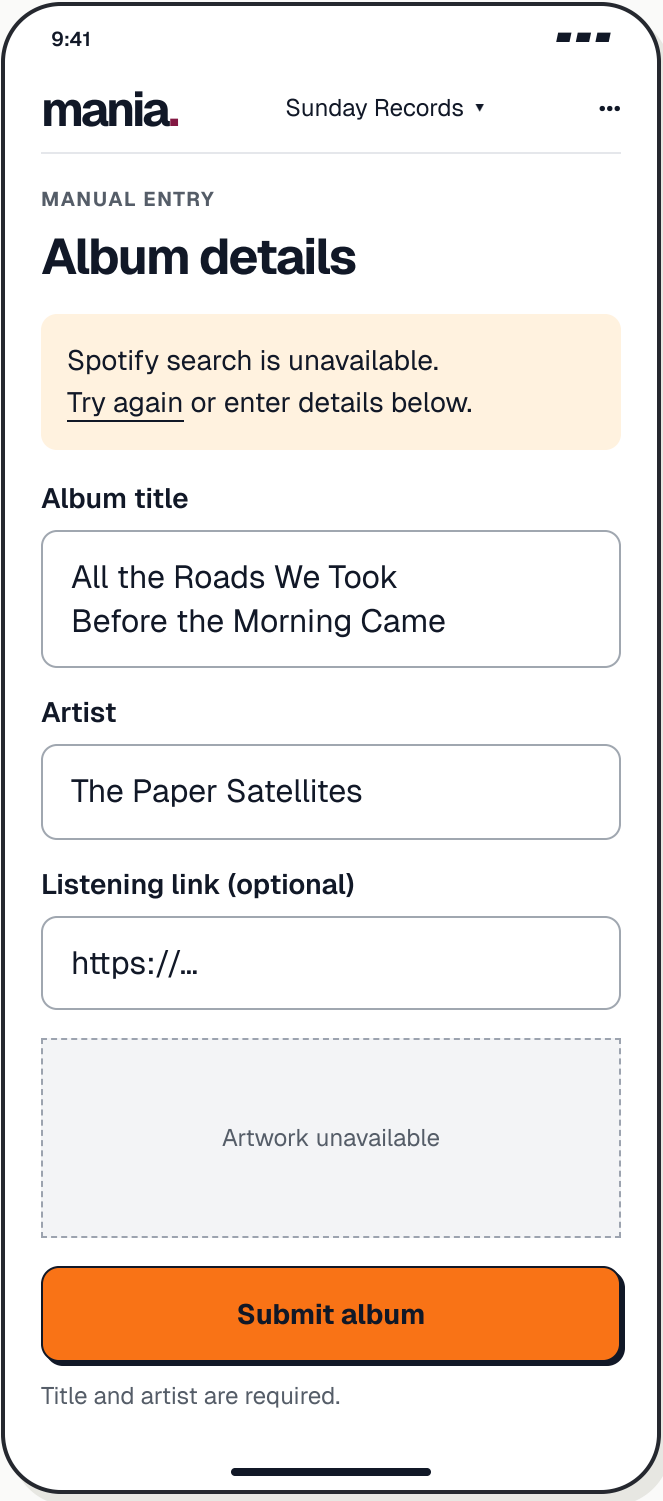
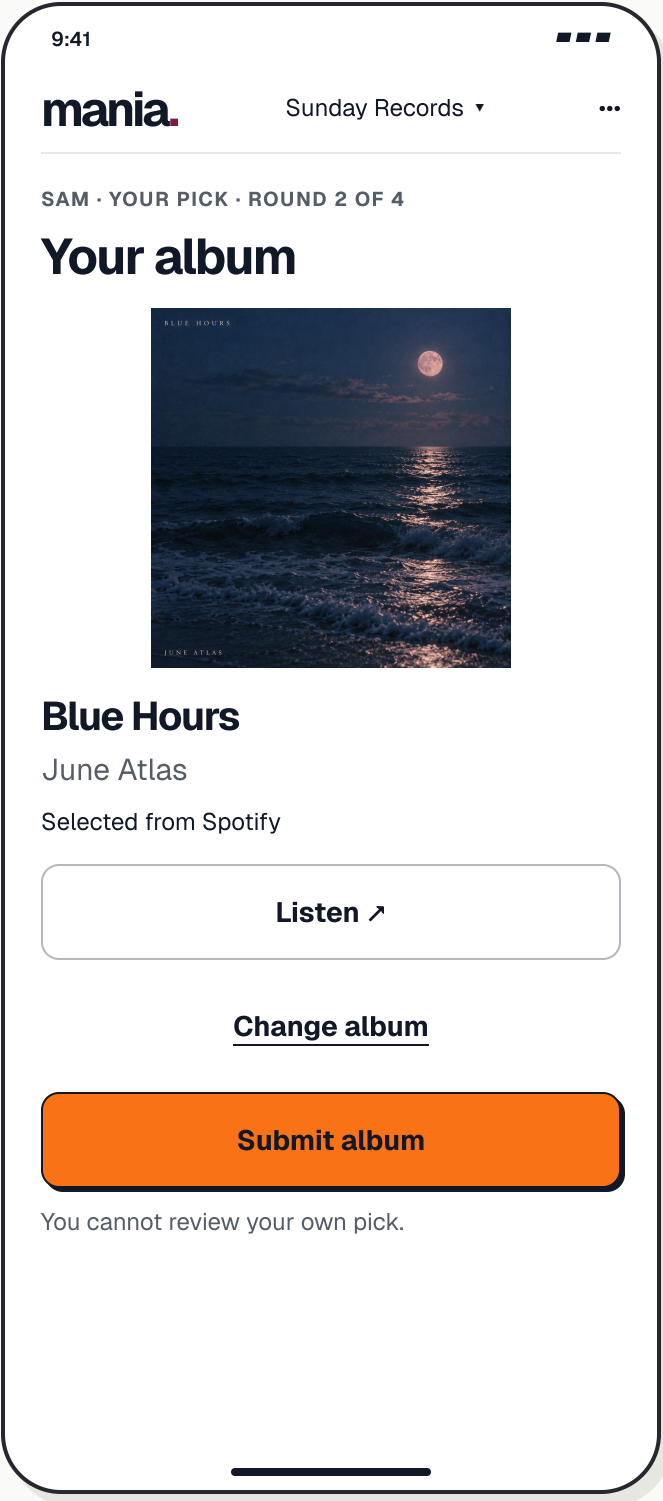
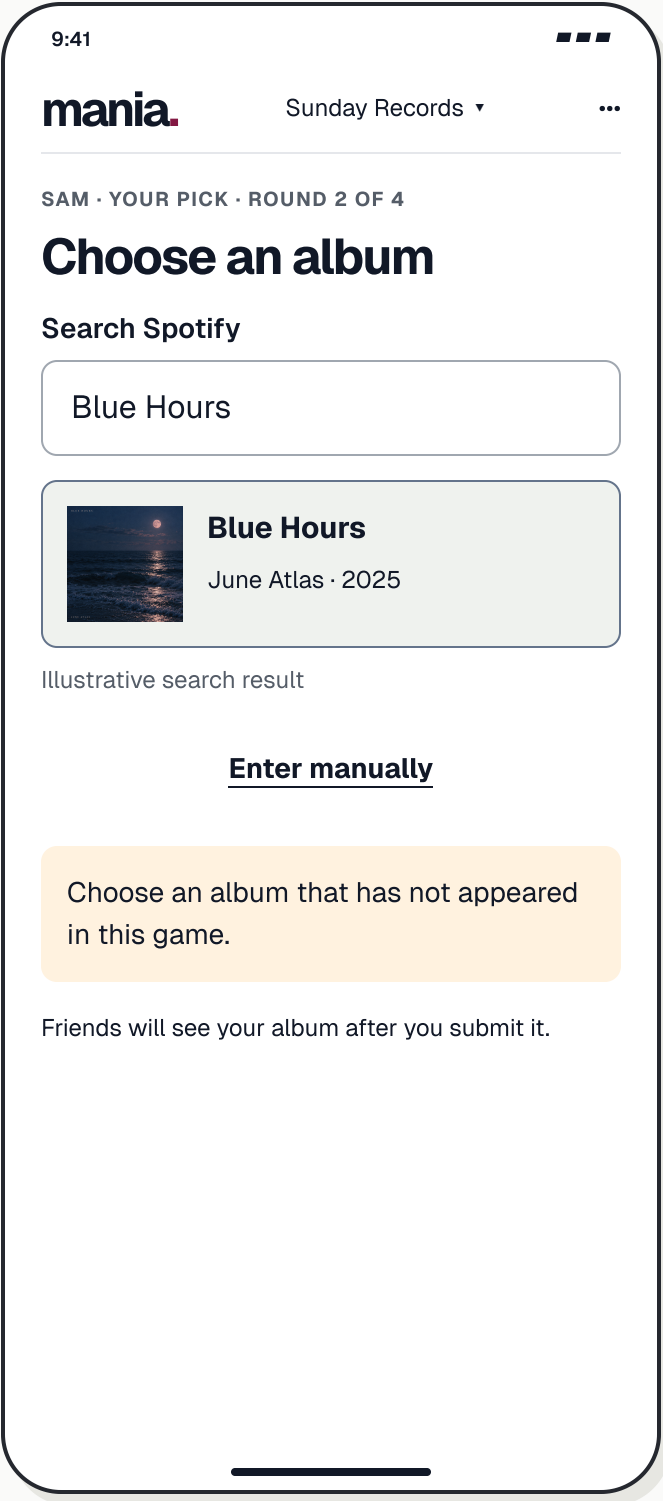
No automatic group rotation, no timers, and no new activity feed required.

BEFORE Signed-in entry still uses a broad marketing-style landing page.

AFTER Show a useful personal entry screen for the selected group.

Choosing an album

Spotify search and manual entry lead to the same reviewable selection.



Search access

Arrow keys move through results. Enter selects. Escape dismisses. Keep visible labels and announce search status.

Recovery

No matches, service errors, and unconfigured search all retain manual entry. Preserve typed values.

Long metadata

Wrap album and artist names. Keep full labels available in results and the selected preview.

Picker only

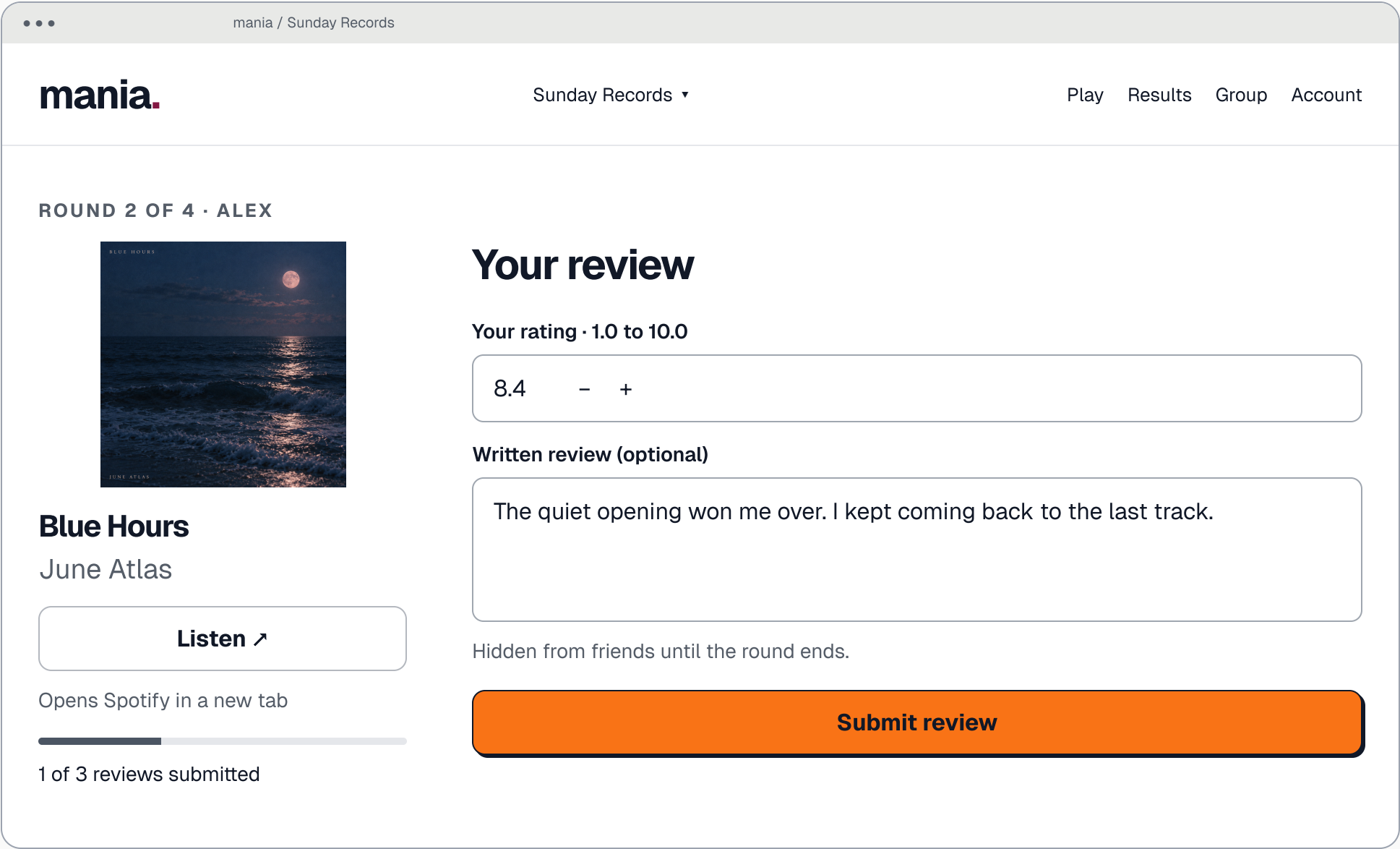
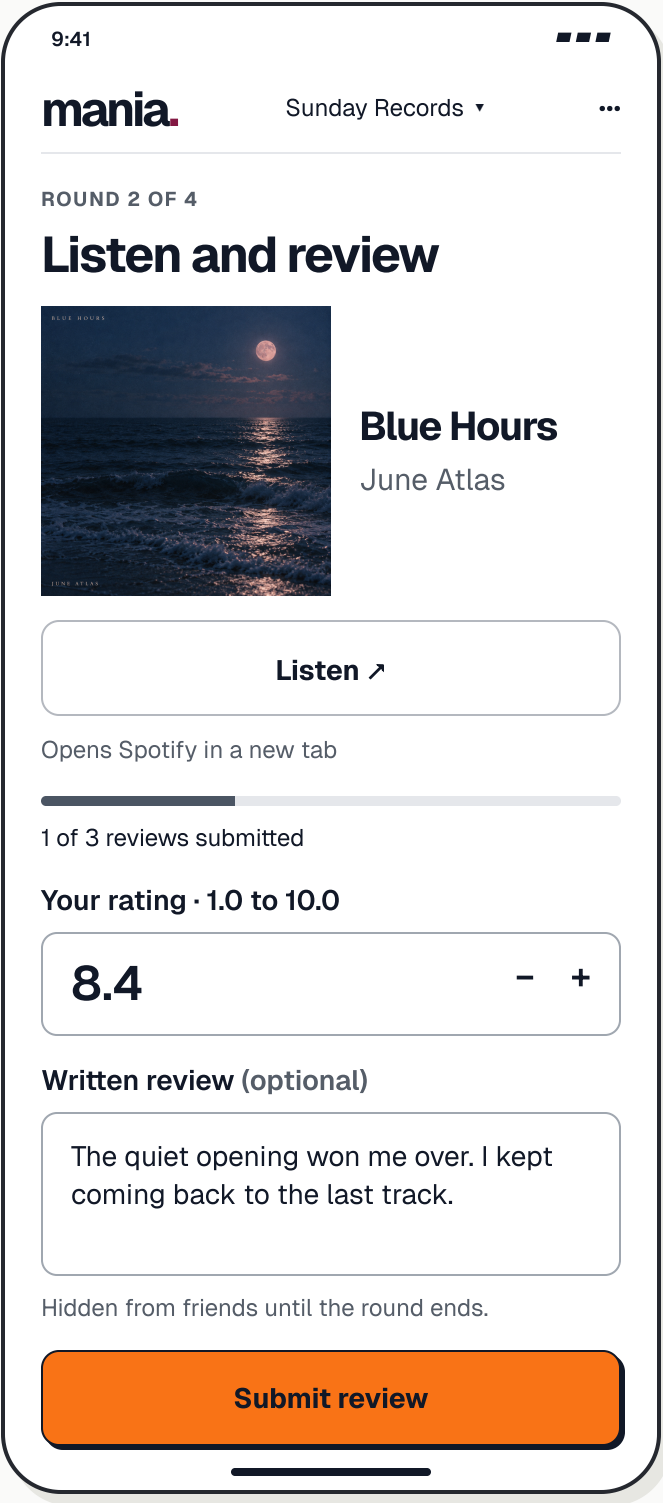
Only the designated picker receives this form. Others see “Waiting for the album.”

BEFORE Search and manual fields share a dense form with a truncated preview.

AFTER Show search, selection, and manual fallback as clear stages without changing submission rules.

Listening and writing a review

One decimal rating control, optional notes, and an obvious listening destination.



One rating value

Numeric input with 0.1 steps, keyboard entry, and decimal keypad. No duplicate quick-score buttons or sentiment labels.

A short phone visit

Listening opens externally. Returning to the tab preserves the in-page draft. Cross-visit draft storage would be additional work.

Submission behavior

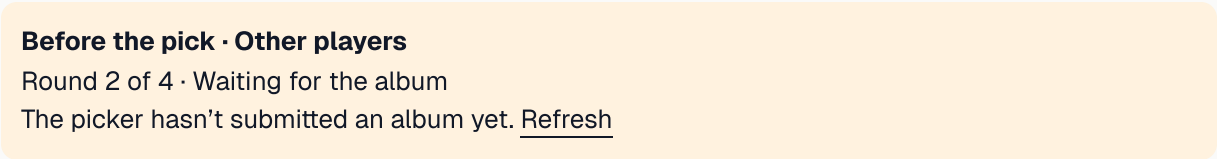
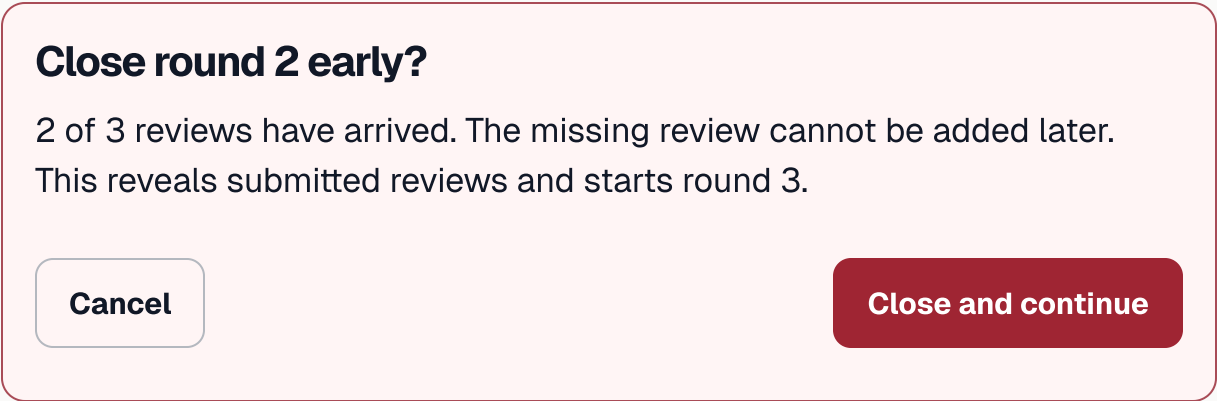
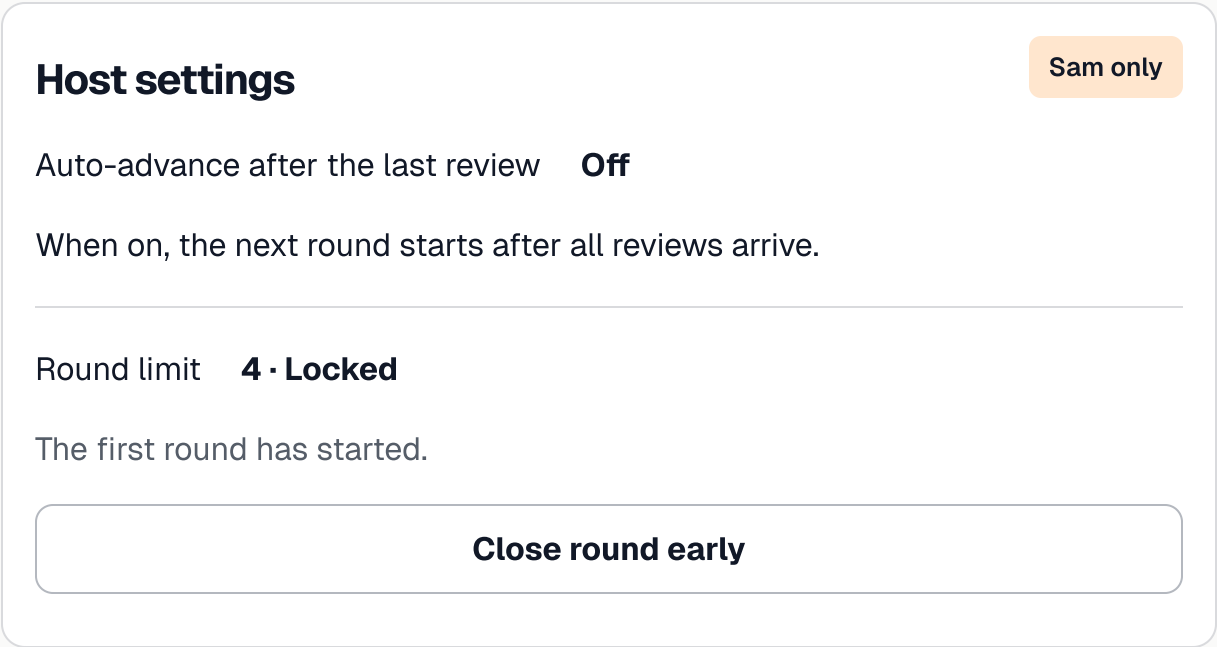
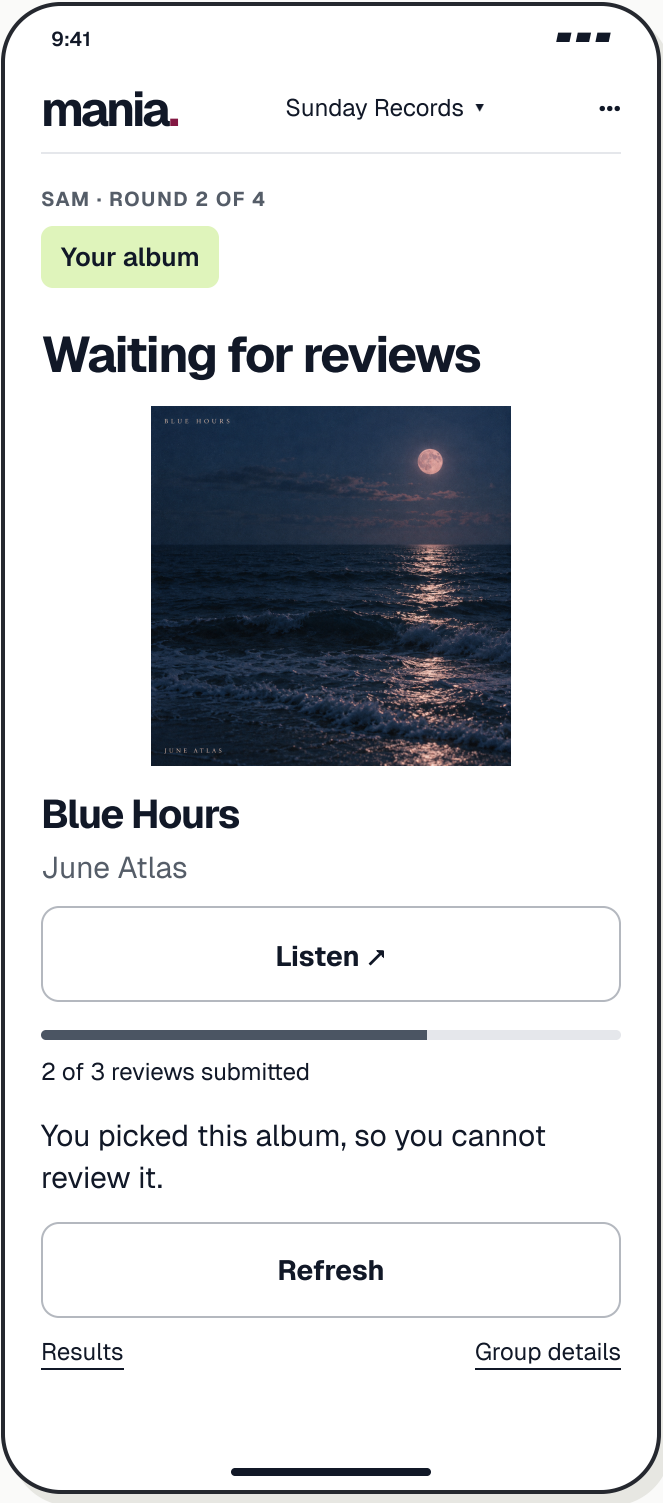
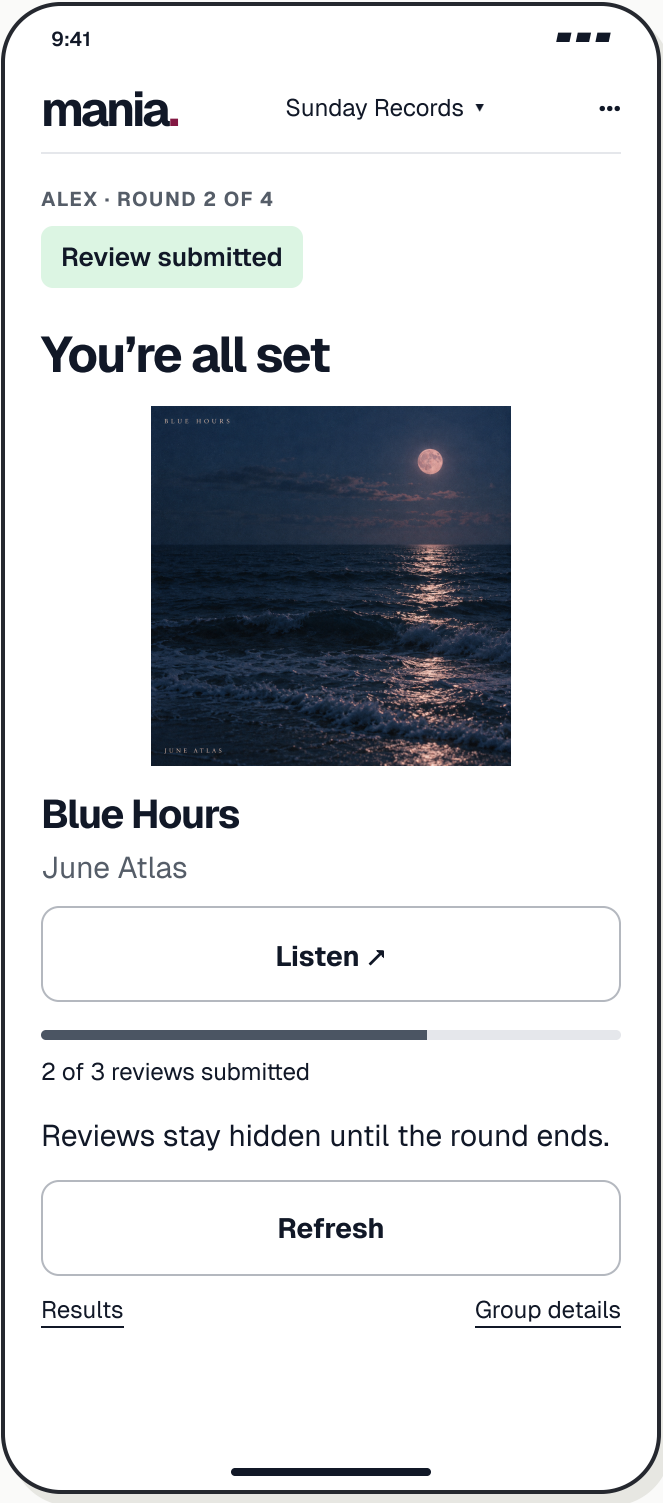
Show “Submitting...” immediately. Confirm only after success. Keep text on failure. One review per player; no edit action after submission.

BEFORE Quick ratings and a live readout add more controls around the same value.

AFTER A single decimal input supports precise ratings while notes remain optional.

Waiting without losing the album

Submitted players and the picker keep their listening link. Host actions live one level deeper.



On the final round: “Close and finish game.” Host only; unavailable while awaiting an album. Do not expose settings to other members.

Progress uses the existing aggregate field. Do not show named pending reviewers or hidden ratings. Confirm aggregate visibility under RLS before implementation.

BEFORE Submission replaces the task surface; host controls compete with it.

AFTER Keep the album in place and move irreversible host actions into a labeled secondary view.

The reveal belongs to the album

Lead with the latest average and friends’ words. Standings are available when someone wants them.

9:41

mania

Sunday Records ▾

...

ROUND 2 OF 4 · REVEALED



8.5

/10

3 reviews

Blue Hours

June Atlas · Picked by Sam

Listen ↗

Alex

8.4

The quiet opening won me over. I kept coming back to the last track.

Priya

8.7

The bass line in the middle stretch is the part I'll remember.

Leo

8.4

A slow start, then a beautiful finish.

Earlier rounds

Standings

Earlier rounds

Close

2 Blue Hours

June Atlas 8.5

1 Small Satellites

The Night Maps 8.0

Only revealed rounds. Selecting one opens its full reviews, artwork, picker and listening link.

Standings

More statistics

Player	Pick average	Picks
Sam	8.5	1
Alex	8.0	1
Priya	—	0
Leo	—	0

More statistics: reviews written, average given, top picks, club average, word count and best round.

Copy results summary

Back to Play

Game complete

Four albums.

More to talk about.

Final-round variant

Read the final reveal, browse all rounds, or return to the group for another game.

See reviews

Open group

Scoring stays the same

Average submitted ratings only. Missing reviews do not count as zero. With no reviews, show “No ratings,” not 0.0.

Next round

Manual mode: host starts it from Play. Others wait. Auto-advance may already have opened the next round; keep the latest reveal reachable.

BEFORE Archive, club totals and rankings crowd the reveal.

AFTER Friends’ reviews lead; earlier rounds, statistics and copied summaries remain labeled controls.

The supporting experiences still matter

Move administration out of the round without removing a single existing action.

Group

Sunday Records

4 of 6 members

SUNDAY4

Copy code

1 Alex

2 Sam

3 Priya

4 Leo

Order is fixed when the game is created.

Before round 1

Round limit · 4 to 500

4

Save round limit

Auto-advance

Off

Start round 1

Host-only setup after Create game.

No game yet? Any member can create one.

Leave group

Account

Display name

Alex

Save display name

Email

alex@example.com

Account ID

Show details

Your groups

Sunday Records

Open group · Leave group

Lunch Break Club

Open group · Leave group

Create group

Join with code or link

Sign out

Leave confirmation: “Your game history stays.” Show the empty-group consequence for the last member. Preserve backend rejection messages.

Game history

Sunday Records · September

Active · Round 2 of 4

Open results

Sunday Records · August

Completed · 4 rounds

Open results

All history remains available from Account, including games from groups the player has left. Open by game ID.

New and late members

No groups: Create or Join. No game: lobby. Late joiner: “You’re in the group. You’ll play in the next game.” No active-game form or protected results.

Authentication remains intact

Log in, sign up, password reset, resend confirmation and email callback retain the invitation or intended destination. No new sign-in method.

Invitation recovery

Invalid code, full group, or expired session gets an inline explanation and a route back to the form. Group capacity remains six.

BEFORE Account and setup details occupy space on Play.

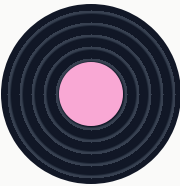
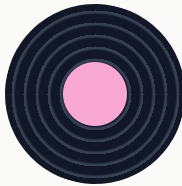
AFTER Group contains membership and game setup; Account owns identity and historical access.

Sources: app/account/*; app/actions/mania.ts; login, signup, reset-password; existing game history queries

11 / 12

Motion, resilience, and implementation

A small transition supports orientation. The task never depends on animation.

1 Ready	2 Opening	3 Play	Reduced motion
			
Start / Resume is a named button.	120–180 ms press and small shift.	Artwork settles. Focus moves to heading.	Immediate navigation. No spin or slide.

Accessible by construction

48 px targets, visible keyboard focus, persistent field labels and status announcements. Keep dark text on bright fills.

At 320 px and 200% zoom, stack columns and allow vertical scrolling. Wrap long titles, URLs and 5,000-character reviews. Preserve review line breaks.

Dialogs trap focus, support Escape where safe, and return focus to their trigger. Never communicate state through color alone.

Failure and edge states

- Missing artwork:** labeled square fallback.
- No listening URL:** show “No listening link.”
- Search fails:** retry or enter manually.
- Submit fails:** keep values and allow retry.
- Stale round:** refresh state and explain closure.
- Long review:** wrap fully or offer Read full review.
- Late joiner:** next-game lobby. **Completed:** final reveal and group entry.
- Duplicate pick:** preserve search and show the existing rejection. Never clear the chosen metadata on error.

Boundaries for implementation

- Reuse current actions, auth and permissions. Keep all hidden review data protected server-side. Recheck role and round on submission.
- Additional client work:** remembered group, auth return context, transition/focus handling. Cross-visit drafts and automatic polling are optional additions, not current guarantees.
- Data check:** reviewProgress exists, but verify cross-player totals under RLS. Named pending reviewers or a picker’s display name on Play need a data-contract review. No new public API is proposed.

Review scope Approve the navigation and state hierarchy before implementation. This proposal changes no application code and introduces no game rules.